

# Nicholas Mac Gregor Garcia

Singapore · 1nicholasgarcia@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/nickmacgregorgarcia · nicholasg3.github.io

English (native) · Portuguese (intermediate) · Mandarin (basic conversational; studied to intermediate level at university)

AI governance researcher and educator at the National University of Singapore. I teach Smart Systems and AI Governance, research how large language models and AI agents can be evaluated and held accountable in regulated settings, and organise multi-stakeholder policy programmes with Google, Asia-Pacific universities, and Singapore's financial-technology ecosystem. I am currently doing computational research on China's AI governance discourse and comparative work on US and Chinese AI policy, and I write for policy and executive readers on AI accountability and disclosure. PhD in Information Systems, New York University (Stern).

## EXPERIENCE

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**Lecturer (Educator Track)**, Department of Information Systems and Analytics, School of Computing, National University of Singapore Nov 2022 – present

- Teach IS4246 Smart Systems and AI Governance, IS4228 Information Technologies in Financial Services, and IS4302 Blockchain and Distributed Ledger Technologies.
- Built course material on privacy, responsible AI and model risk, mapped to Singapore's PDPA, the MAS FEAT principles, the OECD AI Principles and the EU AI Act.
- Lead research on AI governance, LLM evaluation for regulatory use, and decentralised systems, with collaborators including MAS, Google.org, PwC and Data.org.
- Supervised and mentored 30+ students; placements include MAS, Visa, KPMG and Coinbase. Average student evaluation 4.8 / 5.

**Deputy Director; Co-Director (Industry)**, NUS FinTech Lab Nov 2022 – present

- Lead the lab's external engagement and partnerships with industry and public-sector stakeholders, including Ripple, Coinbase and Mastercard.
- Helped secure and renew over SGD 1 million in funding from partners including Google.org, Ripple and Data.org.
- Organised the NUS FinTech Lab Crawl (2023, 2024), an ecosystem event with 500+ attendees; gave the opening remarks and partner briefings.
- Delivered executive briefings on AI evaluation and governance to corporate partners and public-sector agencies.
- Oversee the lab's industry reports, podcast series, internal research projects and incubation of student ventures.

**Lead Academic Organiser, Judge and Advisor**, APRU Asia-Pacific Tech Policy Hackathon 2024 – present

- Co-direct a flagship multi-country programme that brings policy experts, technologists, business leaders and students from Google and Asia-Pacific universities together to design AI governance, data-policy and economic-resilience proposals.
- Ran mentor and judge onboarding, evaluation design and end-to-end operations; coached multi-university teams on AI governance, digital inclusion and financial innovation.

**AI safety education**, Singapore AI Safety Hub (SASH) and Odysea AI 2025 – present

- Facilitator, AI Safety Teaching Collab at SASH: led weekly sessions on AI governance and alignment in a peer-led course built on syllabi by researchers at Harvard, Oxford, Cambridge and OpenAI.
- Advisor, Odysea AI safety course (odysea-ai.org).

**Consultant and Advisor, AI, Data and Technology Policy**, startups, industry consortia and multilateral networks (Asia-Pacific) 2024 – present

- Advise on AI and blockchain strategy, regulatory context, positioning and partnerships; facilitate senior sessions on AI risk management.

**Earlier teaching:** Co-Instructor, Data Analytics for Business, New York University (2020); Instructor, AI ethics and machine learning workshops, Inspirit AI (2021)

## RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

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- Tham, L., Garcia, N. M. G., & Hahn, J. (2026). Internal APIs are all you need: Shadow APIs, shared discovery, and the case against browser-first agent architectures. *arXiv:2604.00694*.
- See, K., Garcia, N., & Li, X. (2025). Simulating blockchain applications in large-value payment systems through agent-based modeling. *AAMAS 2025*.

- Garcia, N., See, K., & Shobri, H. (2024). PSSimPy: A design science approach to constructing and implementing a large-value payment system simulator. *ICIS 2024*.
- Garcia, N. "Rule of code" or "rule of man"? How assumptions of human nature impact the design of blockchain-based algorithmic management systems. Doctoral dissertation, New York University.
- Working paper: Chow, A., & Garcia, N. FairEval: Evaluating LLMs in financial regulation. Target: *MIS Quarterly*.
- Working paper: Peng, C.-Y., & Garcia, N. Governing innovation: A computational analysis of China's AI governance discourse. Lexical-network analysis of China's 2025 *Global AI Governance Action Plan*, CAC, MIIT and MOST policy texts, and state media.
- Policy research: AI for ASEAN Development, FCDO-funded research on AI governance in climate, education and health policy.

### SELECTED POLICY WRITING

Essays for policy and executive readers at [nicholasg3.github.io](https://nicholasg3.github.io), including:

- Who Is Accountable When AI Acts · When AI Disclosure Is Due · What an AI Disclosure Record Must Contain
- What Agents Are Allowed To Do · AI-Written Research Needs Verification Records More Than a Separate Venue

### TALKS AND CONVENINGS

- Speaker, Ethereum Research Forum, ArtScience Museum, Singapore (Sept 2025): blockchain governance and financial systems.
- Panellist and moderator, UNICON 2023, NUS Entrepreneurship Society (600+ participants from 20+ countries).
- Ripple UBRI Connect 2024 (cross-domain risk in arbitrage); DiO Conference 2023 (algorithmic governance); Academy of Management 2020 (ideology in algorithmic governance).

### EDUCATION

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>PhD, Information Systems</b> , New York University, Stern School of Business             | 2022 |
| <b>Master of Information Systems Management</b> , Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College | 2015 |
| <b>BS, Chemical Engineering</b> , University of California, Berkeley                        | 2012 |

### SERVICE AND SKILLS

- Reviewer, International Conference on Information Systems (2018 – present); member, Academy of Management.
- Institutional liaison, APRU–NUS FinTech collaboration; academic advisor, NUS Digital Transformation Leadership Programme (2026).
- LLM benchmarking, explainable AI, multi-agent simulation; Python.